

size fits all. Especially when it comes to EQ settings. Many tend to ignore this, but the right EQ setting for the genre you are listening to is sometimes all that you need to take your experience to the next level. If you do not have a native EQ, then third-party software can come to your rescue. And, in the EQ software, it is recommended that you save EQ presets for different genres. Still not enough? You can also program your own script to identify the genre of music and apply EQ settings if you need to!

13 Headphone calibration

Chances are that if you have good quality headphones, they would have been calibrated at the time of manufacturing itself. While advanced calibration would require special hardware and software that costs north of ₹1,00,000, decent levels of accuracy can be achieved by using simple calibration software that are available online, mostly for free. The easiest way for you to calibrate your headphones is that you take your headphones, play a test tone of 1 kHz and then measure the volume levels on a sound meter or a second device connected to a microphone and a sound level (dB) monitor running. Once that is done, place the microphone at the distance where your ear would be, and change the volume levels of the output from the headphones unless it reaches 60 dB.

14 Invest in high-quality equipment?

If you have reached this part of the article, then I am sure you have already had a thought or two about getting a better pair of headphones or speakers or hardware that'd level up your audio setup. Now, if you are looking for a new addition to your audio setup or an upgrade for your current hardware, then I'd recommend you to go through a guide that I wrote. You can find the article online by following this link – <https://dgit.in/HPFeat>

15 Optimise audio playback

Running regular checks to make sure that your hardware is giving an optimal performance is a given in any

scenario. Make sure that you do regular housekeeping to ensure that all your hardware is running the most optimised setup. Sometimes developers tend to release updates for really dated software as well. So, it doesn't hurt to make sure that you are running the latest software. Not only software, but the hardware, including the cabling, should be regularly inspected.

16 Set up a dedicated environment

Having a dedicated space for listening to audio is not as bad of an idea as it sounds. If you are someone who really cares about the experience but do not want to spend a bomb soundproofing and optimising your room to make the most of the hardware that you have, then setting up a dedicated space is the way to go. For smaller setups, professional consultation is also not required, and you can get things done using off-the-shelf components and some guidance from online tutorials.

17 Experiment with advanced crossfeed algorithms

Crossfeeding, for the uninitiated, is the intentional blending of some parts of a stereo signal to ensure that the headphones sounds more natural and closer to that of speakers. Crossfeeding algorithms have been a point of debate in the audiophile spaces for years now. Crossfeeding, in my opinion, can work wonders for people using headphones that are necessarily not meant for audiophiles. It is very simple to setup, and if you are a fan of an open soundstage, then you should definitely try it out. Here's a link to a quick guide on how you can set it up – <https://dgit.in/CrossAlgo>

18 Great fit always

No, this did not turn into a fashion article all of a sudden. You should ensure that you have a great-fitting pair of earphones/headphones is that – you should make sure that pair that you are getting fits you and forms a tight seal around your ears. Many TWS brands include ear tip fit tests in their apps as well, so I'd say go ahead and take those tests.

19 Digital audio plugins

If you read point #11, you'd know that a plugin, if it fits what you need from your audio system, then it could work wonders for you. However, if you are fond of listening to older tracks that were mastered, keeping in mind the technology of the time, then you should get your hands on the following two kinds of plugins – noise reduction and audio restoration. You might not realise their potential until you use them.

20 DAC or AMP

This is a confusion that even I had when I was starting out. By the looks of it, both devices look very similar, and it seems like they can be interchanged. However, that is not the case. Now, depending on what you have and what you need for your audio setup, you should evaluate your needs. I do not have enough space to describe the differences between the two, but here's are two nifty guides that I found that should help you make your life easier – <https://dgit.in/SG2> | <https://dgit.in/SG1>

21 What is hi-res?

You may have seen many audio devices and software proudly sporting the Hi-Res logo. While in most cases, they do support hi-res audio as per their own definition and standards, as per the popular definition, they are not even close. As defined as "lossless audio that is capable of reproducing the full range of sound from recordings that have been mastered from better than CD quality music sources" by the folks at the Recording Academy and other music labels.

22 Use a high quality music streaming service

If you are into streaming music, then the chances are that you'd be using Spotify, Apple Music, or Amazon Prime Music, or one of the popular platforms. While purists would remark that you should never stream music because of the loss of quality over the stream, if you go for services like Deezer or the like, then you should be set. 